Module -2 Dealing Effectively with People

The English term 'Communication' has been evolved from Latin language. 'Communis and communicare' are two Latin words related to the word communication. Communis is noun word, which means common, communiality or sharing. Similarly, communicare is a verb, which means 'make something common'.

Communication means transferring thoughts, information, emotion and ideas through gesture, voice, symbols, signs and expressions from one person to another. Three things are most important and essential in any communication process they are Sender, Receiver and the Channel (medium).

The sender is encoding the message in any form like voice, written or any signs. So, they are offered as Encoder

The receiver is decoding the message from the sender to understand the message. So, they often called as Decoder.

Channel: Any messages or information needs some channel or a medium. Example: television is an audio visual medium which decodes the electronic signals into an audio visuals to the audience

Communication is simply the act of transferring information from one place, person or group to another.

Formal Channels of Communication Within Organizations

Messages in organizations are sent over both formal (official) and informal (unofficial) channels. Formal communication channels are the official pathways for sending information inside and outside an organization. The primary source of information about formal channels is the organization chart. It indicates the channels the messages are supposed to follow. By carefully following an organization chart, an entry-level worker would know how to transmit a message to someone in the executive suite. Formal communication channels are often bypassed through information technology.

Using e-mail, instant messaging, and intranets, anybody can send a message to anybody else in the organization. During an emergency, workers are also likely to bypass formal channels, such as a technician telephoning the plant manager directly about a chemical spill.

Different modes of formal communication

1.Company Blogs and Social Media Sites as Formal Channels

The company blog is a widely used formal mode of communication, paralleling the use of blogs in private life. Many companies have abandoned their own blogs in favor of using the public blogs of Facebook and Twitter to communicate with the public. Quite often a posting on Facebook or Twitter leads directly to a company website, so the posting is simply a link to the website itself or a blog. However, the website might contain a blog.

2.Social Networking Websites

As a majority of workers have become members of social networking websites such as Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter, and Instagram, these sites have become natural channels for members of the same company to communicate. Research by the consultancy McKinsey and Company shows that more than one half of all firms use some type of social media to facilitate employees collaborating and exchanging information.

3.Intranets

An intranet is essentially a company version of the Internet with the basic purpose of giving employees a central place to find what they need amidst a sea of digital information. The intranet serves as a useful communication channel because updated information is readily available to workers, and the information is centralized, current, and correct.

For example, an employee might want to know the company's per day allowance for meals while traveling. Instead of having to send an e-mail to the boss or human resources department, the employee can search the intranet.

4.Webinars

Another formal communication channel is a web-based method of holding a seminar, referred to as a webinar. The speaker sends information to participants, who can interact with the conference presenter by computer. Collaboration is possible through such means as asking and answering questions. A telephone hookup is also typically used, including a speakerphone so many people at the same time can tune in on the information flow. Slides are displayed throughout the presentation.

The participants in the webinar often are working alone, yet they can be gathered in groups at one or more locations. The meetings can include PowerPoint presentations and streaming videos. Chat is another possible feature, so participants can react to the points raised by other participants.

Communication Channels for Managing Crises

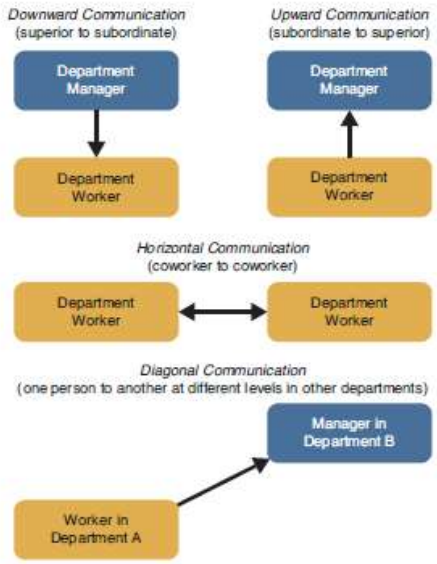
Many companies have developed formal communication channels for managing crises, such as fires and explosions, massive product recalls, financial scandals, and terrorist attacks. One of the most crucial parts of a disaster plan is how to communicate with the company's workforce during a crisis. A key part of the challenge is to locate and reestablish contact with employees who may be scattered in the streets or stranded in airports around the world. Aon Corporation, an international insurance, risk-management, and consulting company, improvised to use its website as an official communication channel during the crisis of September 11, 2001. A company official said, "With everything else down, we decided to use the company website. That seemed like the only option we had."

A more subtle type of crisis is widespread employee fear that the company might lay off large numbers of workers or go out of business. An effective communication strategy is for top management to quickly allay fear if the company is not truly in danger, particularly when suggestions of an impending bankruptcy have been reported in the media. During more recent crises, such as the earthquake in Japan in 2011, multinational

companies made extensive use of intranets and social media to disseminate messages about whether or not company employees were accounted for. Calming messages about the search for the missing were also sent via social media.

Communication Directions

Another aspect of formal communications is the directions messages follow in the organization. Messages in organizations travel in four primary directions: downward, upward, horizontally, and diagonally, as illustrated in the below figure,



Source: "COMMUNICATION DIRECTIONS IN ORGANIZATIONS" by Andrew J. DuBrin.

1.Downward Communication

Downward communication is the flow of messages from one level to a lower level. It is typified by a middle manager giving orders to a lower-level supervisor or by top management sending announcements to employees. Information is sometimes transmitted from a higher level to a lower one without the sender inviting a response. When this occurs, the feedback built into two-way communication is lost.

2.Upward Communication

Upward communication is the transmission of messages from lower to higher levels in an organization. It is the most important channel for keeping management informed about problems within the organization. Simply talking regularly to employees improves upward communication. An open-door policy is a more structured upward communication channel that allows employees to bring a complaint to top management's attention without first checking with their manager. Managers who are willing to listen to bad news without becoming upset at the messenger are more likely to receive upward communication. Upward communication is more widely used in less bureaucratic firms than in highly bureaucratic firms. Almost all executives contend that they value upward communication, although the majority of employees may not think so.

3.Horizontal Communication

Horizontal communication is sending messages among people at the same organization level. It often takes the form of coworkers from the same department talking to one another. Horizontal communication is the basis for cooperation and collaboration. When coworkers are not sharing information with and responding to one another, they are likely to fall behind schedule. Also, efforts are duplicated and quality suffers. Another type of horizontal communication takes place when managers communicate with other managers at the same level.

4.Diagonal Communication

Diagonal communication is the transmission of messages to higher or lower organizational levels in different departments. Because these pathways are infrequently spelled out on the organization chart, diagonal communication is usually an informal channel. A typical diagonal communication event occurs when a manager from one department contacts a lower-ranking person from a department outside of his or her chain of command. Diagonal communication becomes an informal pathway.

Informal Channels of Communication Within Organizations

Informal communication channels are the unofficial network of channels that supplements the formal channels. Most of these informal channels arise out of necessity. For example, people will sometimes depart from the official communication channels to consult with a person with specialized knowledge.

1.Networks of Contacts

Perhaps the most useful aspect of informal communication channels is that they enable workers to accomplish many tasks they would not be able to if they relied exclusively on formal channels.

2.The Grapevine

The grapevine is the major informal communication channel in organizations. The grapevine refers to the tangled pathways that can distort information. The term referred originally to the snarled telegraph lines on the battlefield during the U.S. Civil War. The grapevine is often thought to be used primarily for passing along negative rumors and negative gossip.

3.Chance Encounters and Management by Walking Around

Another informal channel of significance is the chance encounter. Unscheduled informal contact between managers and employees can be an efficient and effective communication channel.

Management by walking around involves managers intermingling freely with workers on the shop floor or in the office, as well as with customers. By spending time in personal contact with employees, the manager

enhances open communication. During contacts with employees the manager will often ask questions such as, “How are you enjoying your work?” or “What bottlenecks have you encountered today?” Because management by walking around is systematic, it could be considered formal. However, a manager who circulates throughout the company is not following the formal paths prescribed by the organization chart. Management by walking around differs from chance encounters in that the latter are unplanned events; the former occur intentionally.

Importance of formal communication at the workplace

Formal communication in the workplace plays a crucial role in fostering a professional environment and ensuring clarity. Here are some key reasons why it's important:

1. **Clarity and Consistency**: Formal communication helps convey messages clearly and consistently, reducing misunderstandings and confusion.
2. **Record Keeping**: Written communication creates a permanent record that can be referenced later, which is essential for accountability and tracking progress.
3. **Professionalism**: It establishes a standard of professionalism, promoting respect among colleagues and enhancing the organization's image.
4. **Efficiency**: Formal channels streamline communication, making it easier to disseminate information quickly and efficiently to all relevant parties.
5. **Conflict Resolution**: A formal process can help address disputes or misunderstandings in a structured manner, ensuring fairness and transparency.
6. **Compliance and Legal Protection**: In many industries, formal communication is necessary for compliance with regulations and can provide legal protection for the organization.
7. **Encourages Feedback**: Formal communication channels often facilitate structured feedback mechanisms, helping to improve processes and employee satisfaction.
8. **Role Clarity**: It helps define roles and responsibilities, ensuring that everyone understands their tasks and expectations.

Overall, formal communication is vital for maintaining a cohesive and productive workplace, fostering collaboration and trust among team members.

Developing a Good Relationship with Your Manager or Team Leader

Getting along well with your manager is the most basic strategy of getting ahead in your career. If you cannot gain favor with the boss, it will be difficult to advance to higher positions or earn much more money. Obtaining good performance reviews and receiving favorable work assignments also depends on a good relationship with the person to whom you report. Workers who have good relationships with their manager have more job

security than those with poor relationships. Your manager or team leader is always the person who is contacted first when someone wants to determine what kind of employee you are. Usually this information is sought.

Variety of approaches that lead to constructive relationships with an immediate superior.

1.Create a Positive First Impression

A logical starting point in developing a good relationship with the person to whom you report is to create a positive first impression. Peter Stephens, a managing director of internships at the Washington Center for Internships and Academic Seminars, offers this advice: “Before setting foot in the office, become a sponge. Exhaust your online resources and briefing materials to absorb anything you can about the organization.

2.Achieve Good Job Performance

Maintaining good job performance remains the most effective strategy for impressing your manager. When any rational manager evaluates a group member’s performance, the first question asked is “Is this employee getting the job done?” And you cannot get the job done if you are not competent. Many factors contribute to whether you can become a competent performer. Among them are your education, training, personality characteristics, job experience, and special skills, such as being able to organize your work. Factors external to you, such as having a supportive boss and cooperative coworkers, also contribute to good performance.

3.Display a Strong Work Ethic

A strong work ethic is a firm belief in the dignity and value of work and therefore is important for favorably impressing a manager. An employee with a strong work ethic will sometimes be excused if his or her performance is not yet exceptional. This is true because the manager assumes that a strong work ethic will elevate performance eventually.

4.Be Dependable and Honest

Dependability is a critical employee virtue. If an employee can be counted on to deliver as promised and to be at work regularly, that employee has gone a long way toward impressing the boss. A boss is uncomfortable not knowing whether an important assignment will be accomplished on time. If you are not dependable, you will probably not get your share of important assignments.

5.Be a Good Organizational Citizen

An especially meritorious approach to impressing key people is to demonstrate organizational citizenship behavior. If people engage only in work included in their job description, an “it’s not my job” mentality pervades. An effective way to impress your manager, therefore, is to demonstrate that you are not constrained

by a job description. If something needs doing, you will get it done regardless of whether it is your formal responsibility.

6.Create a Strong Presence

A comprehensive approach to impressing your manager or team leader and other key people in the workplace is to create a strong presence, keeping yourself in the forefront. Such actions impress key people and simultaneously help advance your career.

7.Find Out What Your Manager Expects of You

You have little chance of doing a good job and impressing your manager unless you know what you are trying to accomplish. Review your work goals and ask clarifying questions. An example would be "You told me to visit our major customers who are sixty days or more delinquent on their accounts. Should I also visit the three of these customers who have declared bankruptcy?"

8.Minimize Complaints

Being open and honest in expressing your feelings and opinions is part of having good human relations skills. Nevertheless, this type of behavior, when carried to excess, could earn you a reputation as a whiner. Few managers want to have a group member around who constantly complains about working conditions, coworkers, working hours, pay, and so forth.

9.Avoid Bypassing Your Manager

A way to embarrass and sometimes infuriate your manager is to repeatedly go to his or her superior with your problems, conflicts, and complaints. Such bypasses have at least three strongly negative connotations. One is that you don't believe your boss has the power to take care of your problem. Another is that you distrust his or her judgment in the matter at hand. A third is that you are secretly launching a complaint against your manager.

10.Engage in Favorable Interactions with Your Manager

The many techniques described previously support the goal of engaging in favorable interactions with your manager.

11.Delivering Bad News

Although favorable interactions with a manager are valuable for relationship building, there are times when a group member has to deliver bad news. For example, you might have to inform the manager about a roof that caved in at a company location, or of customer complaints about a new product. You want to avoid being the messenger who is punished because he or she delivered bad news. Attempt to be calm and businesslike. Do not needlessly blame yourself for the problem. Mention that we are or the company is facing a serious

challenge. If possible, suggest a possible solution, such as, “I have already investigated a temporary location we can use until the damage is repaired.”

When working to establish a good relationship with your manager, keep in mind that cultural factors could influence how a given tactic should be modified for best effectiveness. An example would be that displaying a strong work ethic to a supervisor from Japan would be different from displaying the same work ethic to a manager from France. The Japanese manager might think that working fifty-five hours a week indicates a strong work ethic, whereas the French manager might think that forty hours a week of hard work is exceptional. Another cultural factor in establishing a good relationship could be the amount of respect shown to the manager. A typical American manager might expect an informal, friendly relationship, with the two of you acting like equals. However, a manager from China might expect much more respect. In one situation, a manager from China in charge of a chemistry lab in the United States became angry when workers addressed him by his first name. He expected to be addressed as “Dr.” plus his last name.

Methods and tactics for building coworker relationships include the following:

- Have high self-esteem and be at the center of a communication network.
- Develop allies through being civil.
- Make other people feel important.
- Maintain honest and open relationships (including self-disclosure).
- Be a team player. (Observe the nine approaches reported here.)
- Follow group standards of conduct.
- Express an interest in the work and personal life of coworkers.
- Use appropriate (nonexaggerated) compliments.
- Face maturely the challenge of the office romance.

Conflict

Conflict is a condition that exists when two sets of demands, goals, or motives are incompatible. For example, if a person wants a career in retailing yet also wants to work a predictable eight-hour day with weekends off, that person faces a conflict. He or she cannot achieve both goals. A conflict can also be considered a dispute, feud, or controversy.

Why So Much Conflict Exists

Many reasons exist for the widespread presence of conflict in all aspects of life. All these

reasons are related to the basic nature of conflict: the fact that not every person can have what he or she wants at the same time.

Here we describe nine key sources of conflict:

1.Competition for Limited Resources

A fundamental reason you might experience conflict with another person is that not everybody can get all the money, material, supplies, or human help they want. Conflict also ensues when employees are asked to compete for prizes, such as bonuses based on individual effort or company-paid vacation trips. Because the number of awards is so limited, the competition becomes intense enough to be regarded as conflict.

2.Differences of Opinion on Work-Related Issues and Rights

A natural source of conflict in the workplace centers on differences of opinion about work- related issues, including whose idea will work the best. One member of the design team for a luxury sports car might insist the paneling should be composed mostly of wood. Another might say that the car could get by with plastic paneling, saving the company considerable money. The two members might therefore be in conflict.

3.Incivility

Incivility was described as a frequent problem in getting along with coworkers. Incivility toward work associates can also be regarded as a major contributor to workplace conflict.

4.Personality Clashes and Drama

Many disagreements on the job stem from the fact that some people simply dislike each other. A personality clash is thus an antagonistic relationship between two people based on differences in personal attributes, preferences, interests, values, and styles. People involved in a personality clash often have difficulty specifying why they dislike each other. The end result, however, is that they cannot maintain an amiable work relationship. A strange fact about personality clashes is that people who get along well may begin to clash after working together for a number of years. Many business partnerships fold because the two partners eventually clash.

5.Aggressive Personalities and Workplace Bullies

Coworkers naturally disagree about topics, issues, and ideas. Yet some people convert disagreement into an attack that puts down other people and damages their self-esteem. As a result, conflict surfaces. Aggressive personalities are people who verbally and sometimes physically attack others frequently. Verbal aggression takes the form of insults, teasing, ridicule, and profanity. The aggression may also be expressed as attacks on the victim’s character, competence, background and physical appearance.

Aggressive personalities are also referred to as bullies. Workplace bullying refers to hurtful treatment of others in the workplace that is malicious and typically repeated.

6.Passive-Aggressive Personalities

Another form of aggressive behavior that contributes to job conflict is when someone creates problems by not doing something that needs to get accomplished.

7.Culturally Diverse Teams

Conflict often surfaces as people work in teams whose members vary in many ways. Ethnicity, religion, and gender are three of the major factors that lead to clashes in viewpoints. Differing educational backgrounds and work specialties can also lead to conflict. Workers often shut out information that doesn't fit comfortably with their own beliefs, particularly if they do not like the person providing the information. When these conflicts are properly resolved, diversity lends strength to the organization because the various viewpoints make an important contribution to solving a problem.

8.Competing Work and Family Demands

Balancing the demands of work and family life is a major challenge facing workers at all levels. Yet achieving this balance and resolving these conflicts is essential for being successful in career and personal life. The challenge of achieving balance is particularly intense for employees who are part of a two-wage-earner family. A heavy workload also intensifies the conflict because the person feels compelled to work long hours at the office, in addition to taking work home. Frequent business travel is another major contributor to work–family conflict. Work–family conflict occurs when the individual has to perform multiple roles: worker, spouse or partner, and often parent.

9.Incompatible Demands

Attempting to meet work and family demands is a frequent source of conflict because the demands are often incompatible. Imagine having to attend your child's championship soccer game and then being ordered at the last minute to attend a late-afternoon meeting. As revealed in a study with working adults, another complication of work–family conflict is that when family life interferes with work, the person will often feel guilty.

10.Sexual Harassment: A Special Type of Conflict

Many employees face conflict because they are sexually harassed by a supervisor, coworker, or customers. Sexual harassment is an unwanted sexually oriented behavior in the workplace that results in discomfort or interference with the job. It can include an action as violent as rape or as subdued as telling a sexually toned joke.

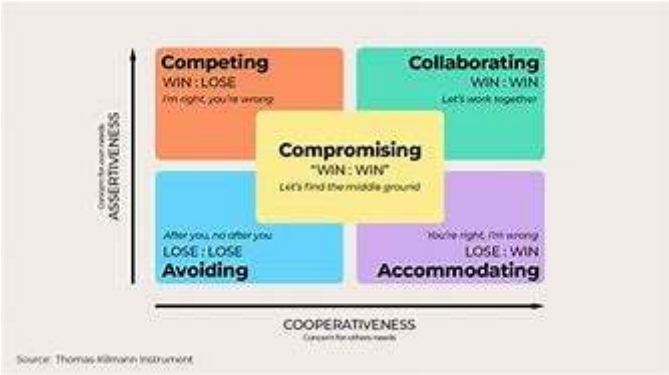
5 Strategies For Conflict Resolution In The Workplace

While there are several approaches to conflict, some can be more effective than others. The Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Model—developed by Dr. Kenneth W. Thomas and Dr. Ralph H. Kilmann—outlines five strategies for conflict resolution:

1. Avoiding
2. Competing
3. Accommodating
4. Compromising
5. Collaborating

These fall on a graph, with assertiveness on the y-axis and cooperativeness on the x-axis. In the Thomas-Kilmann model, "assertiveness" refers to the extent to which you try to reach your own goal, and "cooperativeness" is the extent to which you try to satisfy the other party's goal.

Alternatively, you can think of these axis labels as the "importance of my goal" and the "importance of this relationship." If your assertiveness is high, you aim to achieve your own goal. If your cooperativeness is high, you strive to help the other person reach theirs to maintain the relationship.



Here's a breakdown of the five strategies and when to use each.

1. Avoiding

Avoiding is a strategy best suited for situations in which the relationship's importance and goal are both low. While you're unlikely to encounter these scenarios at work, they may occur in daily life. For instance, imagine you're on a public bus and the passenger next to you is loudly playing music. You'll likely never bump into that person again, and your goal of a pleasant bus ride isn't extremely pressing. Avoiding conflict by ignoring the music is a valid option.

In workplace conflicts—where your goals are typically important and you care about maintaining a lasting relationship with colleagues—avoidance can be detrimental.

Remember: Some situations require avoiding conflict, but you're unlikely to encounter them in the workplace.

2. Competing

Competing is another strategy that, while not often suited for workplace conflict, can be useful in some situations.

This conflict style is for scenarios in which you place high importance on your goal and low importance on your relationships with others. It's high in assertiveness and low in cooperation.

You may choose a competing style in a crisis. For instance, if someone is unconscious and people are arguing about what to do, asserting yourself and taking charge can help the person get medical attention quicker.

You can also use it when standing up for yourself and in instances where you feel unsafe. In those cases, asserting yourself and reaching safety is more critical than your relationships with others.

When using a competing style in situations where your relationships do matter (for instance, with a colleague), you risk impeding trust—along with collaboration, creativity, and productivity.

3. Accommodating

The third conflict resolution strategy is accommodation, in which you acquiesce to the other party's needs. Use accommodating in instances where the relationship matters more than your goal.

For example, if you pitch an idea for a future project in a meeting, and one of your colleagues says they believe it will have a negative impact, you could resolve the conflict by rescinding your original thought.

This is useful if the other person is angry or hostile or you don't have a strong opinion on the matter. It immediately deescalates conflict by removing your goal from the equation.

While accommodation has its place within organizational settings, question whether you use it to avoid conflict. If someone disagrees with you, simply acquiescing can snuff out opportunities for innovation and creative problem-solving.

As a leader, notice whether your employees frequently fall back on accommodation. If the setting is safe, encouraging healthy debate can lead to greater collaboration.

4. Compromising

Compromising is a conflict resolution strategy in which you and the other party willingly forfeit some of your needs to reach an agreement. It's known as a "lose-lose" strategy, since neither of you achieve your full goal.

This strategy works well when your care for your goal and the relationship are both moderate. You value the relationship, but not so much that you abandon your goal, like in accommodation.

For example, maybe you and a peer express interest in leading an upcoming project. You could compromise by co-leading it or deciding one of you leads this one and the other the next one.

Compromising requires big-picture thinking and swallowing your pride, knowing you won't get all your needs fulfilled. The benefits are that you and the other party value your relationship and make sacrifices to reach a mutually beneficial resolution.

5. Collaborating

Where compromise is a lose-lose strategy, collaboration is a win-win. In instances of collaboration, your goal and the relationship are equally important, motivating both you and the other party to work together to find an outcome that meets all needs.

An example of a situation where collaboration is necessary is if one of your employees isn't performing well in their role—to the point that they're negatively impacting the business. While maintaining a strong, positive relationship is important, so is finding a solution to their poor performance. Framing the conflict as a collaboration can open doors to help each other discover its cause and what you can do to improve performance and the business's health.

Collaboration is ideal for most workplace conflicts. Goals are important, but so is maintaining positive relationships with co-workers. Promote collaboration whenever possible to find creative solutions to problems. If you can't generate a win-win idea, you can always fall back on compromise.

Becoming an Effective Leader

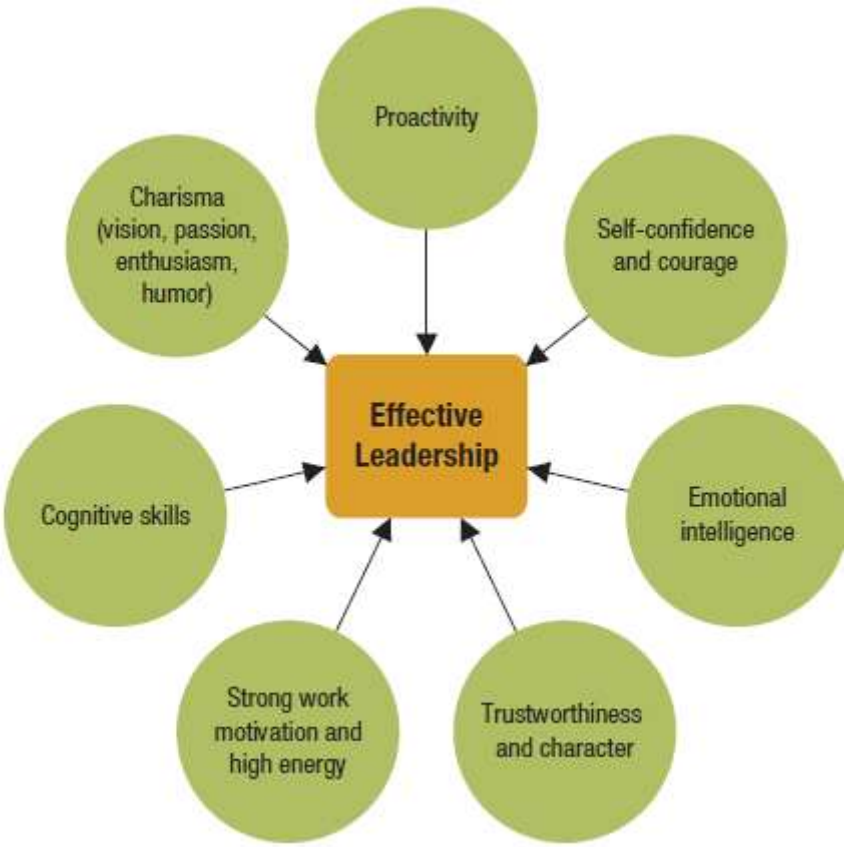
Leadership is the process of bringing about positive changes and influencing others to achieve group goals, along with coordinating the pursuit of these goals. The key words in understanding leadership are change and influence. A leader often challenges the status quo and brings about improvements.

A leader also influences people to do things that they would not do otherwise, such as achieve higher performance. We therefore measure the effectiveness of leaders in terms of the results they attain, such as running a profitable medical clinic or a winning athletic team. In short, the leader makes a difference, particularly with respect to driving performance.

Traits and Characteristics of Effective Leaders

A major thrust to understanding leaders and leadership is to recognize that effective leaders have the "right stuff." In other words, certain inner qualities contribute to leadership effectiveness in a wide variety of situations. Leadership effectiveness in this context means that the leader helps the group accomplish its objectives without neglecting satisfaction and morale.

Here are some of the more important traits and characteristics of leaders. Many of these traits and characteristics can be developed and refined.



Source: “SEVEN KEY LEADERSHIP TRAITS” by Andrew J. DuBrin.

1.Proactivity

Leadership is often regarded as taking the initiative to accomplish something, and a key aspect of proactivity is initiative taking. A person with a proactive personality has a relatively stable tendency to bring about environmental change.4 He or she makes things happen as part of the work role.

2.Self-Confidence and Courage

Self-confidence is necessary for leadership because it helps assure group members that activities are under control. The confidence centers on a belief that a person has the knowledge, skills, and abilities associated with leading others. Assume you are a manager in a company that is facing bankruptcy. You would probably hope that the CEO behaves in a confident, assured manner. The leader who functions best is self-confident enough to reassure others and to appear in control. But if the leader is so self-confident that he so she will not admit errors, listen to criticism, or ask for advice, that too creates problems. Self-confidence often takes the form of the courage to face the challenges of taking prudent risks and taking initiative in general. Courage comes from the heart, as suggested by the French word for heart, coeur. Leaders must be able to face up to responsibility and be willing to put their reputations on the line, even if this means taking a course of action others would not advise.

3.Emotional Intelligence

Emotional intelligence is considered a major contributor to leadership effectiveness because leadership involves so much working with the emotions and feelings of other people. A useful component of emotional

intelligence for leaders is the ability to display warmth before attempting to influence others with knowledge and facts. A body language approach to projecting warmth is to lean forward in a friendly manner to signal interest and engagement.

4.Trustworthiness and Character

Being trustworthy or honest contributes to being an effective leader. An effective leader is supposed to walk the talk, thereby showing a consistency between deeds (walking) and words (talking). In this context, trust is defined as a person's confidence in another individual's intentions and motives and in the sincerity of that individual's words. Leaders must be trustworthy, and they must also trust the group members. Behaving in an ethical manner contributes to being perceived as trustworthy.

5.Strong Work Motivation and High Energy

Leadership positions tend to be both physically and mentally demanding. A successful leader must be willing to work hard and long to achieve success. Many business leaders often work sixty-hour weeks, as do a large number of business owners. Many leaders appear to be driven by a need for self-fulfillment. Another fundamental reason strong work motivation is required for effectiveness is that a person has to be willing to accept the heavy responsibility that being a supervisor entails.

6.Cognitive Skills

Cognitive skills, as well as personality, are important for leadership success. Problem-solving and intellectual skills are referred to collectively as cognitive skills. The term cognition refers to the mental process or faculty by which knowledge is gathered. To inspire people, bring about constructive changes, and solve problems creatively, leaders need to be mentally sharp.

7.Charisma

An important quality for leaders at all levels is charisma, a type of charm and magnetism that inspires others and makes them loyal to the leader. Charismatic leaders are typically assertive because they are eager to reach out to others and express their feelings and thoughts. Research indicates that many charismatic leaders have a moderate degree of narcissism, which enhances their distinctiveness.

Motivation

Motivation has two widely used meanings: (1) an internal state that leads to effort expended toward objectives and (2) an activity performed by one person to get another to accomplish work. Usually the manager is doing the motivating, yet many people in the workplace have a need to motivate others. To accomplish their work, people must motivate individuals who report to them, coworkers, supervisors, and customers. Understanding

how to motivate others, therefore, is essential to your success. It is often important to motivate groups of people, such as a team, in addition to motivating people one at a time.

Techniques of Motivation

Among the standard practices for employee motivation are empowerment, job enrichment, and various forms of positive reinforcement, including financial incentives, recognition, and praise.

1.Empowerment

A comprehensive strategy for employee motivation is to grant workers more power by enabling them to participate in decisions affecting themselves and their work.

Empowerment basically involves passing decision-making authority and responsibility from managers to employees. A key point is that the leader shares power with group members. Because group members have some power, they can influence the manager, such as giving him or her guidance.

2.Job enrichment

Job enrichment refers to making a job more motivating and satisfying by adding variety and responsibility. A job is considered enriched to the extent that it demands more of an individual's talents and capabilities. As the job becomes more meaningful to you, you become better motivated and, it is hoped, more productive. Unless you want an enriched job, these positive results may not be forthcoming. Substantial research and practical experience have gone into enriching jobs. Three noteworthy characteristics of an enriched job are direct feedback, client relationships, and new learning.

3.Motivation through Positive Reinforcement

Positive reinforcement means increasing the probability that behavior will be repeated by rewarding people for making the desired response. The phrase increasing the probability means that positive reinforcement improves learning and motivation but is not 100 percent effective. The phrase making the desired response is also noteworthy. To use positive reinforcement properly, a reward must be contingent on doing something right. Simply paying somebody a compliment or giving the person something of value is not positive reinforcement. Because financial incentives, recognition, and praise are given for attaining a given goal, they function as positive reinforcement.

a.Financial Incentives as Positive Reinforcement

Money is a natural motivator, and no program of motivation can exclude the role of financial compensation. Even the most ardent critics of the motivational power of money recognize that nonfinancial motivators are effective only when compensation is considered to be fair and adequate.

Linking Compensation to Performance

Many employers make a systematic effort to link some portion of pay to performance to make pay more motivational. Variable pay (or merit pay) is an incentive plan that intentionally pays good performers more money than poor performers. Employees receive more money by excelling on performance measures such as number of sales or number of computer programs completed.

Personal Factors Influencing the Power of Financial Incentives

Individual differences profoundly influence the motivational power of financial incentives. Workers who attach a high value to financial incentives will be more motivated by money than those who attach a low value. A major influencing factor is that money is a good motivator when you need it badly enough.

Problems Created by Financial Incentives

Despite their effectiveness as motivators, financial incentives also create human problems. A major concern is that financial rewards can lead a person to focus on rewards rather than the joy built into exciting work. Another problem is that after people receive several increases based on performance, merit pay comes to be perceived as a right or entitlement. A person who does not receive a merit increase one quarter often feels that he or she has been punished. Another problem with cash awards is that they sometimes interfere with teamwork as employees concentrate on individual financial rewards. Also, pay-for-performance plans can prompt executives, corporate professionals, and sales representatives to focus on achieving exceptional financial results, sometimes by unethical means.

b.Motivation through Recognition and Praise

The workplace provides a natural opportunity to satisfy the recognition need, the desire to be acknowledged for one's contributions and efforts and to feel important. A manager can thus motivate many employees by making them feel important, or at a minimum, saying "Thank you" for a job well done. Employee needs for recognition can be satisfied both through informal recognition and by establishing formal recognition programs. If the recognition prize is made contingent on achievement, the recognition program functions like positive reinforcement.

Praise as Recognition

Praising workers for good performance is closely related to informal recognition. An effective form of praise describes the worker's performance rather than merely making an evaluation. Describing good performance might take this form: "You turned an angry customer into an ally who referred new business to us." A more general evaluation would be "You are great with angry customers."

Although praise costs no money and requires only a few minutes of time, many workers rarely receive praise.

Team

The term team is used frequently in human relations, yet it merits a formal definition. A team is a small number of people who are committed to common goals and approaches to which they hold themselves mutually accountable. A group is slightly different because it has less emphasis on teamwork. It is a collection of people who interact with one another and are working toward some common purpose. All teams are groups, but not all groups are teams: A team approaches being a supergroup. For a collection of people to function well as a team or a group, they must collaborate, such as in solving problems together.

Significance of teamwork at the workplace:

Teamwork in the workplace is essential for several reasons:

1.Enhanced Productivity: Collaborative efforts often lead to faster problem-solving and more efficient completion of tasks, as team members can share workloads and combine their strengths.

2.Diverse Perspectives: A team brings together individuals with different skills, experiences, and viewpoints. This diversity can lead to more creative solutions and innovation.

3.Improved Communication: Working in teams fosters open communication, helping to clarify ideas, expectations, and feedback. This can reduce misunderstandings and improve overall workflow.

4.Support and Motivation: Team members can provide emotional support and encouragement, boosting morale and motivation. A strong team can help individuals feel valued and connected.

5.Skill Development: Collaboration allows team members to learn from each other, enhancing their skills and knowledge. This continuous learning can lead to personal and professional growth.

6.Accountability: Being part of a team encourages accountability, as individuals feel responsible not just for their tasks but also for supporting their colleagues and contributing to the group's success.

7.Adaptability: Teams can respond more effectively to changes and challenges. A collective approach allows for flexible problem-solving and adaptation to new circumstances.

8.Stronger Relationships: Teamwork fosters camaraderie and builds trust among colleagues, creating a positive workplace culture that can lead to lower turnover rates.

9.Better Decision-Making: Collaborative discussions often lead to more informed and balanced decisions, as multiple viewpoints are considered before reaching a conclusion.

Overall, effective teamwork can significantly contribute to a positive work environment and drive organizational success.

Diversity

Diversity refers to the variety of differences among people in an organization. These differences can include but are not limited to race, ethnicity, gender, age, sexual orientation, religion, disability, socioeconomic status, and cultural background. Embracing diversity means recognizing, respecting, and valuing these differences in individuals. In the workplace, diversity fosters creativity, innovation, and a broader range of perspectives, which can lead to better problem-solving and decision-making.

Diversity can manifest in many forms across various contexts. Here are some examples:

1.Cultural Diversity: Different cultures represented in a community, such as various ethnic backgrounds, traditions, languages, and customs. For example, a city with significant immigrant populations may celebrate festivals from different cultures.

2.Linguistic Diversity: The presence of multiple languages within a population, like in a multilingual country where residents speak various native and second languages.

3.Gender Diversity: Representation of different gender identities and expressions, including male, female, non-binary, and genderqueer individuals in workplaces or social settings.

4.Age Diversity: A mix of different age groups, such as a workplace that includes young professionals, mid-career individuals, and seniors, each bringing unique perspectives.

5.Religious Diversity: A variety of religious beliefs and practices, such as a community where Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Buddhism, and secular beliefs coexist.

6.Ability Diversity: Inclusion of individuals with varying abilities and disabilities, ensuring that environments are accessible and that all voices are heard.

7.Socioeconomic Diversity: A range of economic backgrounds, from low-income to affluent individuals, contributing to a richer understanding of societal issues.

8.Neurodiversity: Inclusion of people with different neurological conditions, such as autism, ADHD, and dyslexia, promoting varied ways of thinking and problem-solving.

9.Sexual Orientation Diversity: Representation of different sexual orientations, such as heterosexual, homosexual, bisexual, and asexual individuals, fostering an inclusive environment.

10.Political Diversity: A variety of political beliefs and ideologies within a group, promoting dialogue and understanding across different viewpoints.

These examples highlight the richness that diversity brings to societies, workplaces, and communities, enhancing creativity, innovation, and empathy.

Cross-cultural competence

Cross-cultural competence, also known as intercultural competence, refers to the ability to effectively interact and communicate with people from different cultural backgrounds. It involves understanding, appreciating, and adapting to cultural differences in values, norms, communication styles, and behaviours. Cross-cultural competence enables individuals to navigate diverse work environments, collaborate with colleagues from various cultural backgrounds, and build positive relationships across cultures. It also helps prevent misunderstandings, conflicts, and barriers to teamwork.

Significance of cross-cultural competence:

In human relations at work, diversity and cross-cultural competencies are crucial for several reasons:

1. **Inclusivity and Equity**: Embracing diversity creates an inclusive work environment where all employees feel valued, respected, and included, regardless of their background. This fosters a sense of belonging and equity, which can improve morale, engagement, and retention.
2. **Innovation and Creativity**: A diverse workforce brings together individuals with different perspectives, experiences, and expertise. This diversity of thought fosters creativity and innovation, leading to better problem-solving and the development of new ideas and products.
3. **Global Collaboration**: In today's globalized economy, many companies operate across borders and cultures. Cross-cultural competence enables employees to effectively collaborate with colleagues, clients, and partners from different cultural backgrounds. This is essential for building successful international teams, managing global projects, and expanding into new markets
4. **Conflict Resolution and Communication**: Cultural differences can sometimes lead to misunderstandings or conflicts in the workplace. Cross-cultural competence helps employees navigate these challenges by

promoting effective communication, empathy, and cultural sensitivity. This facilitates conflict resolution and strengthens relationships among team members.

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